

Financial Confidence for Her Wellbeing

The Companion Workbook — Reflection & Self-Assessment Exercises

Based on the book by Dr. Mavis Mazhura

This workbook belongs to:

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook is a companion to Financial Confidence for Her Wellbeing. It gathers the reflection prompts, self-assessments, and exercises from the book into one place, with space to write your answers directly.

A few notes as you begin:

- ☐ Read one chapter of the book, then complete the matching section here — don't rush ahead.
- ☐ There are no right answers. Rate and answer honestly, based on where you actually are, not where you think you should be.
- ☐ Keep a journal nearby for any answer that needs more space than is given here.
- ☐ Revisit sections over time — your values, goals, and resilience will shift as your life does.

"You didn't create your money mindset, but you can redesign it."

FOUNDATIONS

Part 1: Understanding Your Money Story

Corresponds to the opening chapters on hidden money scripts and inherited conditioning.

Reflection: Your Inherited Money Messages

- Write down three money messages you inherited (from family, culture, religion, or early experience).

-
- Circle — or note here — the one you're most ready to question.

-
- Now rewrite your new truth about money and worth, in your own words.

Pause Point

- What beliefs about money felt familiar as you read this chapter?

-
- Where did they come from, and who did they serve?

- Do they still deserve a place in your life?
-

ELEMENT ONE

Part 2: Financial Self-Determination

Reclaiming the right to direct your financial life through values, vision, goals, and conscious decision-making.

Financial Self-Determination Self-Assessment

Use this tool to reflect, not to judge. Rate yourself honestly on your current reality, not where you think you should be. Mark the box that fits: 1 = Strongly disagree ... 5 = Strongly agree.

A. Values, Vision, and Direction

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I have defined my personal financial values (what money represents and what matters most to spend it on).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I intentionally review my financial values as my life and priorities change.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have a written financial vision that guides my decisions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have written short-term financial goals that reflect my values and vision.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have written long-term financial goals that reflect my values and vision.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I use a system to track progress toward my financial goals.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am aware of where my financial knowledge is strong and where it needs strengthening.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

B. Planning, Learning, and Belief Awareness

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I have written down financial learning goals.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understand my financial needs through a financial needs analysis.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have a written financial plan based on my needs (debt repair, earning, managing, investing, protecting).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am aware of my beliefs about earning, debt, managing money, investing, and protection.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I consciously reflect on and update my financial beliefs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understand how my upbringing and early experiences shaped my financial behaviour.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection

- When are you choosing intentionally?

- When are you still deferring — out of habit, fear, loyalty, or exhaustion?
-

- What one practice — values review, goal tracking, or learning — would most strengthen your financial confidence right now?
-

Worksheet: Your Financial Freedom Number

This figure represents the asset base needed to maintain your current lifestyle without actively working.

Formula: $(\text{monthly expenses} \times 12) \div 0.08$

- My current monthly expenses: R _____

- Annual expenses (monthly $\times$ 12): R _____

- My Financial Freedom Number (annual expenses $\div$ 0.08): R _____

- What does this number make me feel, and what is one thing it clarifies about my choices?

Debt Self-Determination

- How much debt do I want to carry, and how much is too much?

- What debt serves my future, and what debt limits my freedom?

- By when do I want to be financially free, or at least financially flexible?

Earning Self-Determination

- Am I waiting to be paid, or deciding what I want to earn?
-

- Do I want my income to grow by 10%, 15%, or 20% year on year — and what would that require?
-

- Which income sources do I currently rely on, and which could I intentionally build (earned, profit, interest, dividend, rental, capital gains, royalty)?
-

Money Management Self-Determination

- What expenses truly support my life and wellbeing?
-

- What percentage of my income is allocated to present needs versus future security?
-

- What financial commitments limit my flexibility — and which ones expand it?
-

Investment Self-Determination

- What am I investing for: security, freedom, legacy, or flexibility?
-

- What level of risk aligns with my current life responsibilities?
-

- Which assets match my values and time horizon?
-

Protection Self-Determination

- What do I currently have in place: life insurance, disability/income protection, medical cover, a will, an estate plan?
-

- What is the one protection gap that, if closed, would give me the most peace of mind?
-

- Who and what is my financial life meant to serve if I weren't here to manage it?
-

ELEMENT TWO

Part 3: Financial Resilience

Building the capacity to hold steady when life disrupts your plans.

Your Resilience Map

Answer honestly, without judgement.

1) Shock Absorption

- If I lost income tomorrow, how many months could I cover my essentials?

-
- What is my priority: emergency fund, debt reduction, or income growth?
-

2) Income Agility

- If my current role ended, what skill would help me find new work fastest?

-
- What is one capability I can build this quarter to increase earning stability?
-

3) Cash Flow Control

- Do I know exactly where my money goes each month?

-
- What is one expense leak I can close without punishing myself?
-

4) Debt Flexibility

- Which debt reduces my freedom the most?

-
- What one action would reduce that debt's grip: extra payment, renegotiation, consolidation, or boundary setting?
-

5) Protection

- What risk would harm me most right now: health, income loss, or dependents?

-
- What is one protective step I can take in the next 30 days?
-

Now Reflect

- Where am I most resilient already?
-

- Where am I most exposed, and what emotion comes with that exposure?
-

- What is one small, stabilising action I will take this week?
-

Reflection

- Identify one financial setback you've had. Write what it taught you, not what it took from you.
-

Financial Resilience Self-Assessment

This assessment is not a test. It is a mirror. Rate each statement 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree). Leave blank if not applicable.

A. Day-to-Day Stability and Control

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I feel in control of my day-to-day, month-to-month finances.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel behind with my finances.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have the courage to live within my income.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel on track to pay off my debt.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel I can manage a financial setback or shock (income loss, illness, divorce, unexpected expense).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection prompt: Where does instability come from — lack of income, lack of structure, or emotional avoidance?

B. Forward Momentum and Support Systems

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I feel on track to meet my financial goals.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have a good credit record and access to affordable credit if needed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I consult a financial advisor or planner at least once a year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can identify appropriate financial products for my needs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have people who could support me in a financial emergency.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can rely on others to grow my financial knowledge.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have insurance that adequately covers my financial risks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection prompt: Where am I relying on hope — and where have I built actual support?

C. Protection, Alignment and Capacity

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I have prepared for estate duty or asset transfer.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have the courage to negotiate prices or repayment terms.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I continually build skills to increase my earning power.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My financial decisions align with my values (freedom, security, travel, dignity).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I manage my finances in a way that makes me feel secure.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am building wealth, not only paying off debt.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection prompt: Which decisions would change if I trusted myself more?

D. Tangible Results and Financial Momentum

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I am accelerating my home loan repayment, or I have paid off my home loan.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have a debt repayment plan that reduces my debt yearly.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My earnings grow by at least 10% per year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My financial skills increase each year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with my standard of living.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have emergency reserves covering 6–12 months of expenses.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection prompt: Which results reflect consistency — and which reflect once-off effort?

E. Systems, Assets and Future Protection

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Payments and savings are automated.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have income-generating assets.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I budget for personal development.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My net worth grows each year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My property investment value grows.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have funds or cover for death-related costs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection prompt: What would still work if I had less energy this year?

F. Legal, Medical and Knowledge Foundations

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I have an up-to-date will.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have adequate medical cover.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have education savings for dependents.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have adequate life cover.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have an estate plan or transfer funding.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understand core financial concepts (inflation, compound interest, credit, pensions).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reflection prompt: Which gaps feel overwhelming — and which are simply unattended?

Interpreting Your Results

- ☐ High agreement across sections: your resilience is layered and stable.
- ☐ High agreement in A but low in D or E: you're coping, but not yet compounding.
- ☐ Low agreement across sections: focus on stabilisation before growth.
- ☐ Mixed results: this is normal — resilience is built in phases.

ELEMENT THREE

Part 4: Financial Wellbeing

Wellbeing is not about having more — it's about having certainty, competence, connection, and autonomy.

Financial Wellbeing Emotional Index

For each statement, rate how often it feels true for you, then average each dimension. 0 = Never · 1 = Rarely · 2 = Sometimes · 3 = Frequently · 4 = Almost always · 5 = Always.

Dimension 1: Financial Distress and Emotional Residue

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Embarrassment about my financial upbringing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hopelessness about debt	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Stress around day-to-day finances	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Anxiety or fear when talking about money	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fear about insufficient future investments	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Dimension 1 average score: _____ | Higher (3–5): emotional distress is actively shaping your money behaviour. Moderate (2–3): functioning, but carrying unprocessed pressure. Lower (0–1): more available for strategic engagement.

Dimension 2: Emotional Safety and Future Security

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Confidence in future earning ability	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
A sense that my financial legacy is protected	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Peace with my financial upbringing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Gratitude for my current financial situation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hopefulness about becoming debt-free	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Calm in managing monthly finances	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Dimension 2 average score: _____ | Higher (3–5): money feels stabilising rather than threatening. Moderate (2–3): some security, but uncertainty still influences decisions. Lower (0–1): a lack of felt safety may be driving fear-based choices.

Dimension 3: Positive Financial Engagement and Trust

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Willingness to talk about money	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Excitement about investments and plans	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Confidence in earning ability	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Trust in my financial skills	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feeling connected to my personal finances	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feeling that my assets are protected	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Dimension 3 average score: _____ | Higher (3–5): emotionally engaged with money in a way that supports growth. Moderate (2–3): engagement is emerging but may feel effortful. Lower (0–1): avoidance or disconnection may be limiting confidence.

Reading Your Profile Holistically

- ☐ High distress + low engagement suggests emotional work is needed before strategy.
- ☐ Low distress + low safety points to planning and protection gaps.
- ☐ High safety + high engagement reflects strong financial wellbeing.
- ☐ Mixed scores indicate transition: growth is under way, but not yet integrated.

Reflection: What Does Wellbeing Feel Like for You?

- When do I feel most at ease about money?

- Where does stress still live in my financial life?

- Do I feel more in control of today, or more anxious about tomorrow?

- What would financial wellbeing feel like in my body, not just look like on paper?

- What is one practice I can strengthen to support that feeling?

WHOLE-LIFE VIEW

Part 5: Life Integration

Money doesn't live in isolation — it moves through home, career, and mind. Reflect on each dimension below.

Home and Household

Family of Origin

- What money roles did I learn in my family of origin?
-
- Who earned, who managed, who sacrificed, and who decided?
-
- Which of those roles am I still carrying — by default rather than by choice?
-

Household Labour and Care

- How are household duties and caregiving recognised — or not recognised — in financial decisions?
-
- What would change if this labour were acknowledged and valued?
-

Structure and Security

- Do I know the legal and financial structures that govern my household (marriage contract, asset ownership, beneficiaries, wills, contingencies)?
-
- If life changed suddenly, would I feel financially prepared — or exposed?
-

Integration

- What financial responsibilities am I carrying that were never meant to be mine alone?
-
- Where do I need clearer boundaries: with family, dependents, or myself?
-
- What one honest money conversation would reduce tension and increase stability in my home?
-

-
- What does a financially integrated home look like for me?
-

Career and Financial Alignment

Career Direction

- Do I have a clearly written career goal, or am I relying on being noticed?

- What role, level, or influence am I intentionally working towards?

Career and Financial Alignment

- How does my current role contribute to my long-term financial vision?

- Is it building skills, visibility, networks, and leverage — or is it merely sustaining me?

Earning Strategy

- Am I earning primarily through effort, or through influence and leverage?

- What would need to change for my income to grow without working harder?

Capability Building

- What skills, experiences, or exposure would significantly increase my earning ability in the next two to three years?

- Have I intentionally invested in these, or postponed them?

Strategic Positioning

- When am I over-functioning operationally and under-positioning strategically?

- What work could I delegate, stop, or redesign?

Agency and Control

- What beliefs do I hold about control over my career progression?
-

- Do I see myself as an active designer or a passive participant?
-

Courageous Conversations

What conversations am I avoiding that could accelerate my growth?

- ☐ Promotion discussions
- ☐ Role clarity or scope expansion
- ☐ Compensation or visibility
- ☐ Sponsorship or advocacy

Fear vs Confidence

- If I were making career decisions from confidence rather than fear, what would I do differently?
-

Redefining Success

- What would career success look like if it supported both my wellbeing and my financial freedom?
-

Immediate Action

- What one intentional action can I take this quarter to position myself, rather than waiting, for growth?
-

Mental and Educational

What ultimately empowers action is not just effort, but the quality of the ideas we hold about money.

Avoidance vs Engagement

- In what areas of my financial life am I avoiding rather than engaging, and what am I protecting myself from?
-

Cognitive Load

- What currently consumes most of my mental bandwidth, leaving little space for financial thinking or planning?
-

Quality of Ideas

- What ideas, beliefs, or narratives about money am I repeatedly operating from, and in what ways might they be outdated or inherited?
-

Learning vs Stagnation

- When was the last time I deliberately upgraded my thinking about money through reading, learning, or meaningful conversation?
-

Emotional Awareness

- What emotions surface when I think about money — stress, confusion, shame, numbness, or curiosity — and what do they signal?
-

Confidence Building

- What one area of financial knowledge, if strengthened, would immediately reduce my anxiety and increase my confidence?
-

Identity Shift

- How might my relationship with money change if I saw learning as identity development rather than as fixing a deficiency?
-

From Information to Action

- What is one small, practical learning action I can take this month to move from avoidance to informed engagement?
-

Work–Life Integration

Reflection: From Fragmentation to Integration

Take a moment to reflect — not from judgement, but from curiosity:

- Which life dimension is currently overdrawn?
-

- Where am I compensating financially for misalignment elsewhere — through spending, overworking, or self-sacrifice?
-

- What role am I carrying that no longer belongs to me, but continues to draw on my time, energy, and money?
-

CLOSING

Your Confidence Continuum

"Your relationship with money is not fixed. Your conditioning is not your destiny. And your confidence is not something you wait for; it is something you practise."

Final Reflection

- Looking back across this workbook, what pattern keeps showing up for you?
-

- What is one boundary, conversation, or decision you are ready to make differently?
-

- What would it look like to check back in with this workbook in six months?
-

This work is not about perfection; it is about presence. Return to these pages as often as you need.